

INSIDE K.L. RAHUL'S T20 REBUILD

A deeper look at how **Rahul's offside** retreat and straight-line focus have redefined his T20 game in IPL 2025 — and boosted his strike rate.

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In the rapidly evolving world of T20 cricket — where strike rates and boundary percentages have soared — K.L. Rahul (left facing) has often appeared a reluctant participant.

But in the ongoing Indian Premier League season, the Karnataka batter has found a way to break free from the mental shackles that previously held him back, thriving in a fresh middle-order role for Delhi Capitals (DC).

In 10 matches in IPL 2025, Rahul has amassed 381 runs at an average of 47.63 and a seven-year-high strike

rate of 142.16. His resurgence is not merely the result of a positional tweak or mental switch — it reflects a fundamental shift in his batting approach.

A comparison of Rahul's run-scoring zones across the last four IPL seasons highlights the change. **Formerly a predominantly offside player, he has reduced the proportion of runs scored in that region to just 17.8% this season. That's a sharp drop from 38.2% in the 'Offside V' — between third man and extra cover — in 2024.**

DC's clash against Royal Challengers Bengaluru at the M. Chinnaswamy Stadium showcased Rahul's remodelled game. Thrust into the PowerPlay after early wickets, the

« **Rahul has scored 70.5% of his drive runs in the 'Straight V' — nearly twice last season's share from same zone**

